

IMPROVISED ARMS

During insurgencies and revolutions, some combatants may not have production arms at their disposal. They may use handmade arms that have been produced based on necessity. These firearms vary enormously in their quality and performance—from crude guns made of metal pipes to sophisticated submachine-guns. These weapons are often poor in construction and are generally unable to withstand the pressure developed during the ignition of a cartridge. This makes them likely to blow up when in operation.



Trigger

Bolt handle

Stock reminiscent of a Lee-Enfield

Cartridge case from 20mm cannon shell serves as barrel

Hole used to ignite charge

Wire wrapping secures barrel to stock

Muzzle

Perforated barrel shroud serves as the fore grip

Smoothbore barrel

Foresight

Roughly carved wooden grip

Rear sight

Trigger

Cocking handle

Barrel

Break-open hinge

Pistol grip

► **EOKA PISTOL**

Date 1950s

Origin Cyprus

Barrel 4¼in (11cm)

Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.54mm)

The *Ethniki Organosis Kyprion Agoniston*, or National Organization of Cypriot Fighters (EOKA), fought a guerrilla campaign against British colonial rule on the Mediterranean island of Cyprus from 1955 to 1959. During that time, they created small numbers of crude guns. This pistol is so crudely fashioned that it barely qualifies for the name. The barrel is a spent 20mm caliber cartridge case, secured to a rough-hewn wooden frame. Since it had no rifling, the most effective way of firing would have been by putting the “muzzle” up against the enemy’s body before the gun was discharged.

◄ **EOKA SHOTPISTOL**

Date 1950s

Origin Cyprus

Barrel 4¼in (11cm)

Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.54mm)

Eoka built this weapon in the 1950s. Made from iron piping, it has a simple break-open action. It fires a shotgun cartridge by means of a spring-loaded plunger.